

RUSSELL OLIVER

GENERAL MANAGER MARKETING | STRATEGIC FORCE MULTIPLIER

Rakaia, Canterbury, NZ | russell.olivernz@gmail.com | +64 27 543 9970



EXECUTIVE PROFILE

You don't build a globally relevant outdoor brand by relying on bloated external agencies. You build it by embedding extreme capability directly into your internal teams. For over two decades, I have operated at the intersection of high-consequence military operations, advanced digital infrastructure, and consumer marketing.

I function as a practitioner-educator. I engineer the high-level marketing architectures required to capture global market share, and then I directly train the cross-functional teams required to execute them. By combining tertiary marketing qualifications with rigorous military leadership, I build marketing departments that operate with absolute strategic clarity, a customer-first mindset, and uncompromising accountability for ROI.



CORE COMPETENCIES

- Global Marketing & Brand Strategy
- Customer Experience (CX) Transformation
- Cross-Functional Team Leadership
- ROI Measurement & Accountability Frameworks
- Digital Architecture & Sovereign Infrastructure
- Enterprise AI Integration (FDV Framework)
- Public Relations & Consumer Loyalty
- Crisis Management & Cultural Transformation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director & Full-Stack Marketing Strategist
Creative Startup NZ

Oct 2019 – Present

I architect digital infrastructure and marketing ecosystems for over 70 enterprises across the Trans-Tasman region. I don't just hand founders a strategy document; I build the systems that force revenue growth.



- Engineered multi-channel marketing funnels and conversion architectures that generated an average 9.14% monthly revenue growth across the client portfolio.
- Deployed advanced Generative AI frameworks to scale digital content operations, actively navigating strict data sovereignty and mitigating algorithm hallucinations to preserve authentic brand voice.
- Designed bespoke, mobile-first web platforms prioritizing customer experience (UX/UI) and WCAG-compliant accessibility, significantly lowering user friction and bounce rates.
- Established rigorous analytics frameworks using Google Analytics to shift marketing decisions from instinct-driven to data-proven, ensuring absolute accountability for ad spend.

Managing Director & Digital Strategist ***Romantic Gestures Ltd***

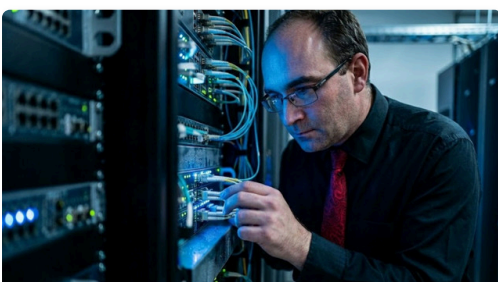
Jan 2014 – Present

I built and scaled a highly visible B2C lifestyle brand from the ground up, navigating a saturated market by owning the organic search space and focusing relentlessly on the customer journey.

- Captured and held the #1 organic Google ranking for highly competitive industry terms by executing aggressive Technical SEO and structured data implementation.
- Scaled a complex e-commerce infrastructure supporting over 45 products, backed by a highly accountable affiliate network of 60+ nationwide partners.
- Directed all Public Relations, brand communication, and loyalty initiatives, culminating in the "Couples Choice Award 2025," directly validating our market positioning and consumer trust.

Operations, Logistics & Internal Capability Educator ***New Zealand Defence Force (NZDF)***

Feb 1999 – Present



High Reliability Organizations (HROs) do not tolerate failure. I spent 23 years leading cross-functional teams through volatile operational environments, focusing heavily on cultural transformation, logistics, and internal upskilling.

- Acted as a true organizational force multiplier. Maintained active legal certifications to assess and train personnel

internally, completely eliminating the need for expensive external training vendors.

- Directed high-consequence enterprise supply chains using SAP S/4HANA. Overhauled operational workflows under severe environmental constraints to boost team output by 33% within six months.
- Managed complex crisis response scenarios. Deployed strict, objective leadership frameworks (OODA Loop, GSMEAC) to stabilize operations and maintain team morale during periods of extreme ambiguity.
- Authored high-level strategic policy papers, achieving a 99% benchmark grade for a comprehensive organizational analysis on workforce retention and cultural health.

ACADEMIC QUALIFICATIONS & MICRO-CREDENTIALS

Artificial Intelligence for Business Leaders (Level 5 Micro-credential)

Open Polytechnic of New Zealand | Awarded: Apr 2026

Mastered the FDV (Feasibility, Desirability, Viability) Framework to align enterprise AI adoption with top-line business objectives while mitigating risk.

Graduate Diploma in Business

Open Polytechnic of New Zealand | Awarded: Dec 2025

New Zealand Certificate in Business (First Line Management) (Level 4)

Ignite Colleges & Premier Institute of Education | Awarded: Dec 2023

Bachelor of Business (Marketing) (Level 7)

Open Polytechnic of New Zealand | Awarded: Mar 2022

Diploma in Marketing (Level 5)

Open Polytechnic of New Zealand | Awarded: Dec 2019

National Certificate in Adult Education and Training (Level 4)

Learning State | Awarded: Jul 2012